

History

U.S.





About the Course

Read United States history stories from the current history cycle (1800-1900). View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts as appropriate for student level.



Placement & Combining Tips

History courses are on a four-year rotation. Students should follow the current Alveary rotation.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
2-3	History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) 1 time/week 20 min	Escape by Night: A Civil War Adventure Dandelions Buffalo Bird Girl: A Hidatsa Story Coolies Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)				
				History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)



Escape by Night: A Civil War Adventure



Dandelions



Buffalo Bird Girl: A Hidatsa Story



Coolies



Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History.\)](#)

∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 1 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 1

Kentucky

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

Have you heard the name Abraham Lincoln? What do you know about him? He was the 16th President of the United States. However, no one would have assumed a boy born in a log cabin and who barely went to school would grow up to become the President. This is the story of his life.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Log cabin

This is a replica or copy of the one-room log cabin that Abraham Lincoln was born in. What would be hard about living in there with your family? You can see the inside of a cabin in your book.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas p.14-15

Find Kentucky. This is where Abraham Lincoln was born.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.5-14 "It was a" - "was only seven."

- How is Abraham's life different from yours?
- How was life harder back then in the 1800s?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Photograph of Abraham Lincoln

You can use this for your timeline.

WEEK 2 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 2

Indiana, His Good Stepmother

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ RECAP

What have you learned about Abe Lincoln so far?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas

1.p.14-15 Find Indiana. They are moving to another state. Which direction is Indiana from Kentucky?

2.p.91 What river makes up the border between Kentucky and Ohio? (Ohio River)

→ INTRO

How did people cross rivers in those days when there weren't many bridges? One way is a log raft ferry similar to the one in the picture.

∞ Image Link: Log raft ferry

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.15-26 "Summer days went" - " school start up."

- What kinds of hardships has Abe already faced when he was just a boy?
- What signs of hope was there in his life?

→ VIEW

Describe the kind of work that is going on in the picture on p.18-19. Would you enjoy doing that kind of work in order to live?

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 3 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 3

His Good Stepmother, The River and the Law

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

Why do you think as many people didn't know how to read back then? (few schools, books are hard to find, busy trying to survive) What advantage would someone have who knew how to read?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas p.10-11

In the last chapter, we read about Abe and his family crossing the Ohio River. Now Abe is going to travel on the Mississippi. Trace the route from the Ohio River in Indiana to where the Mississippi River flows into the ocean. Do you know what city and state it flows through? (see p.14-15- New Orleans, Louisiana) You will find out more about that city in this chapter.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-35 "The winter Abe" - "about moving again." (You may want to stop throughout the reading to have your student narrate)

- Why do you think Abe was so interested in reading?

→ PROMPT

Image Link: Painting of a steamboat

WEEK 4 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 4

1830

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas

1.p.14-15 Find Springfield, Illinois. Abe and his family are moving around that area.

2.Which direction are they traveling from Indiana?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-46 "February 12" - "mastered the rules."

- What do you think would be the hardest part of moving to a new area and starting again?
- What do you think Mr. Rutledge meant, "All he lacks is culture to reach a high place in life?"

→ VIEW

Image Link: Prairies of Illinois

• DEFINITIONS

unwieldy: not easy to manage or control (p.38)

yarns: a tall tale (p.38)

WEEK 5 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 5

1830, Mary Todd

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

If you don't know how to do something or don't know much about a subject, what steps would you take to learn about it? When Abe didn't know about something, he read a book about it. And that was at a time when it was hard to find books. If you remember, he didn't even finish one

• EXTRA HELPING

Video Link: This video shows the New Salem historical site where they reconstructed the town where Abe lived in the 1830s.

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

year of formal school.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.46-56 "By spring" - "the Edwards' house."

- What stands out to you about the character of Abe?
- What characteristics seem to set him apart from other people?

WEEK 6 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 6

Mary Todd, Lawyer

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

When we think of famous people from the past we often think that everything just went well for them and they went straight to the top. But as we can see with Lincoln, there are a lot of setbacks and discouragements along the way.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-67 "November 4" - "his own state."

- Discuss some of the challenges and obstacles Abe faced and how he responded to them.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Home of Lincoln and Mary that they lived in from 1844 to 1861, when he became President. It is a historic site you can visit.

WEEK 7 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 7

President

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of US in 1854

1. Look at the map key. What does orange mean? What does green mean?
2. Where are most of the states that allow slavery located? Why do you think that is the case?

We will read about a series of debates between Lincoln and Stephen Douglas that made Lincoln a household name across the country. Here is the question they were discussing: How do the new states decide if they will allow slavery or be a free state? These debates were very exciting for the people of Illinois. It was like a sporting event with crowds, music and souvenirs.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.68-75 "One spring day" - "into the fog."

- What are some of the differences between Lincoln and Douglas?
- Do you think Douglas was surprised that Lincoln did so well in the debates? What do you think prepared him for these moments?

→ VIEW

1. ∞ Image Link: Life-size bronze statues of Lincoln and Douglas at their 8th debate in Alton, Illinois.

2. Did you catch the name they gave to Lincoln during his campaign—Honest Abe, the Rail Splitter? Even though he was now a lawyer, he had split rails in his youth, and this image of him hard work and self-reliance was something many voters could relate to. This is a color reproduction of an 1858 painting.

• DEFINITIONS

secede: to separate from a nation or state and become independent

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 8 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 8

1861

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

Do you think it would be fun to be a child in the White House? William was 11 and Tad was 8 when their dad became President. Tad was known for his antics around the White House. He once discovered how to make all of the White House bells ring at the same time—much to the surprise of the entire staff and residents of the building!

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas p.14-15

Find Washington, DC. This is where Lincoln is going to now that he is President. Which direction is it from Springfield, Illinois?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.77-86 "February,1861" - "the White House."

- Do you think being President of the US is a hard or easy job? Why or why not?

→ VIEW

Image Link: Confederate flag from 1861 housed in the Smithsonian

• EXTRA HELPING

This is a short video about the beginning of the war at Fort Sumter.

Video Link: Fort Sumter

WEEK 9 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 9

Emancipation

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

Abraham Lincoln is considered by many to be the greatest US President. In this chapter, we will read about one of the things he did that makes him so great.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.87-93 "Freeing of the" - "Pursuit of Happiness."

2.Read the first paragraph of the Emancipation Proclamation.

(Emancipation means freeing from bondage. Proclamation is an official statement or announcement made by the government.

"That on the first day of January, in the year of our Lord one thousand eight hundred and sixty-three, all persons held as slaves within any State or designated part of a State, the people whereof shall then be in rebellion against the United States, shall be then, thenceforward, and forever free; and the Executive Government of the United States, including the military and naval authority thereof, will recognize and maintain the freedom of such persons, and will do no act or acts to repress such persons, or any of them, in any efforts they may make for their actual freedom."

• EXTRA HELPING

This chapter mentioned the telegraph office. This video tells the history of the telegraph.

Video Link: History of telegraph

WEEK 10 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 10

At Gettysburg

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas

1.p.14-15 Find Pennsylvania. Where is it in relation to Washington, DC?

2.p.47 This is just a map of Pennsylvania. Find Gettysburg right over the southern border of the state. This area became a national cemetery for many of the soldiers that died and it was the place where an important speech was given by President Lincoln called The Gettysburg Address.

• DEFINITIONS

orator: a person who makes speeches and is very good at making them (p.94)

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1		
	→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.94-103 "Only one of" - "feel any easier." • Do you know what Lincoln meant by four score and seven years ago? (score means 20, 87 years ago in 1776.) • Is there anything we can do to honor those who sacrificed their lives for the freedom of our country? → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 11	📖 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 11 <i>The Last Day</i> 📄 Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p. 104-109 "Friday, April 14," - "from the earth." • Discussion Question Idea → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the book using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.
WEEK 12	📖 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 12 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: ABRAHAM LINCOLN: AN INITIAL BIOGRAPHY	

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 1 **20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 13**

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Escape By Night

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.1

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 2 **20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 14**

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Escape By Night

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.2

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 3 **20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 15**

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Escape By Night

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.3

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 4 **20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 16**

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Escape By Night

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.4-5

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 5 **20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 17**

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Escape By Night

→ **INTRO**
Information



Term 2	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.6-7 → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 6 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 18 Main Idea/Subtitle Materials: Escape By Night → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.8-9 → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 7 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 19 Main Idea/Subtitle Materials: Escape By Night → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.10-11 → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 8 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 20 Main Idea/Subtitle Materials: Escape By Night → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.12-13 → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 9 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 21 Main Idea/Subtitle Materials: Escape By Night → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.14-15 → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 10 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 22 Main Idea/Subtitle Materials: Escape By Night → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.16-Epilogue → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 11 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 23	
WEEK 12 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 24 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: ESCAPE BY NIGHT	

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 3

WEEK 1	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 25 Main Idea/Subtitle Materials: → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.16-Epilogue → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 2	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 26	
WEEK 3	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 27	
WEEK 4	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 28	
WEEK 5	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 29	
WEEK 6	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 31	
WEEK 8	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 32	
WEEK 9	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 36	

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

Examination

Term 1

· Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

Tell all you know about the story of Abraham Lincoln's journey from his childhood to becoming president during the Civil War.